

BUDDHISM CANON

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Abstract

Example

hadleylab.org Governed Research. Every claim cited.

Contents

The foundational declaration: suffering (dukkha) exists, has a cause (tanha), has an end (nirodha), and there is a path (magga).

Example: I teach one thing and one thing only: suffering and the end of suffering (attributed to the Buddha). This is the D everything in Buddhism derives from this diagnosis.

2. Three Marks of Existence

All conditioned phenomena are impermanent (anicca), unsatisfactory (dukkha), and without self (anatta).

Example: Anatta (no-self) is Buddhism's most radical claim directly opposing the Hindu Atman. Sabbe dhamma anatta all phenomena are not-self. The evidence is meditative experience (vipassana), not textual argument alone.

3. Dependent Origination

Nothing arises independently. All phenomena arise in dependence on conditions (pratityasamutpada).

Example: The twelve-link chain: ignorance formations consciousness name-and-form six senses contact feeling craving clinging becoming birth aging-and-death. Break any link, end suffering.

4. Sangha as Refuge

The Buddhist community (sangha) is one of the Three Jewels (Buddha, Dharma, Sangha). Taking Refuge IS conversion.

Example: Buddham saranam gacchami, Dhammam saranam gacchami, Sangham saranam gacchami. The triple refuge formula defines the relational boundary one becomes Buddhist by taking refuge.

5. Vinaya (Monastic Discipline)

The monastic code (Vinaya Pitaka) governs ordained life: 227 rules for bhikkhus, 311 for bhikkhunis.

Example: The Patimokkha recitation every uposatha (lunar) day, monks gather and confess violations against the code. This is operational governance through confession and communal accountability.

6. Institutional Lineage

Buddhism transmits through ordination lineage (nikaya), teacher-student transmission, and monastic institutions.

Example: Theravada traces ordination to the Buddhas original sangha. Zen traces dharma transmission through 28 Indian patriarchs to Bodhidharma to China. The lineage IS the structural continuity.

Constraints

MUST: Cite canonical source (Pali CANON, Mahayana sutras) for doctrinal claims
MUST: Distinguish Theravada from Mahayana from Vajrayana traditions
MUST NOT: Conflate Buddhist philosophy with Hindu metaphysics

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